

Desk Research Task:

Executive Summary:

- Booking Formula 1 races weekend is spread across several different services ; the official F1 Ticket Store, Circuit Specific event apps, F1 Paddock Club and third-party resellers. Causing separation and fragmentation in the process of booking tickets for the F1

Across sources, we could observe six different clustered theme that was recurring across platforms.

1. **High-demand purchase meltdowns** (Website crashes, Multi-hour virtual queues, payment failure during sale)
2. **No real seat selection** (seats are allocated by the promoter, leading to undisclosed restricted view seats)
3. **Misleading availability** (“Sold out”) shown for ticket that are still available elsewhere
4. **Fragmented apps & accounts** (too many F1 apps/logins; the ticket lives in a different app then where they have purchased it)
5. **Delivery & entry anxiety** (tickets arriving very late or never, mobile only entry risk at the gates)
6. **Policy, price & support friction** (non-refundable/non-changeable orders, reseller markup and slow customer service)

Pain point findings:

1. **High-demand purchase meltdowns** (Website crashes, Multi-hour virtual queues, payment failure during sale)
 - The most complaint that was present during the research occurred at on-sale for popular races. At the 2022 Singapore GP on-sale, fans reported virtual queues of 3.5 – 6 hours, being kicked out of the queue, and the payment systems failing. One of the fans have waited for hours to realise to hit an error saying the sales has stopped, and a delayed paid for grandstand link that was too late to use[3]. For the 2022 US GP (Austin), fans described the presale links routing to a checkout that “hung forever”, making transactions nearly impossible while resale sites advertised the inventory[4].

- Comparable hot on sale ticking systems show the same failure signature that G1 buyers describe. Long waits ending with an error, carts emptying at the seat selection step, and being thrown to the back of the queue after hours of waiting. Reinforcing that this is a systemic weak point at the purchase moment, not a one-off
- 2. No genuine seat selection/undisclosed restricted view seats.
 - On the official store there's no way to pick for a specific seats like in the cinema. F1's FAQ states seat allocation is handled by the promoter on a first come basis and buyers can only submit "preferences", with final allocation confirmed later[1]. This produces a recurring grievance of buyers report being allocated restricted view states with no warning and no option to decline, then being told tickets are non-refundable when they complain[2]. Reviewers argue restricted view seats should be disclosed and discounted rather than sold blind.
- 3. Misleading availability (Displaying it as "sold out" when it's not)
 - Multiple buyers report the store showing certain day tickets as "sold out" when the same tickets were still available directly via the circuit. One reviewer has stated single and two day tickets were shown unavailable while the local promoter still had them [2]. On the Austin thread, the official channel showed "sold out" while resellers openly listed many seats at inflated prices [4]. Whether caused by allotment logic, bots, or channel splitting, the perception is artificial scarcity that pushes fans toward pricier channels.
- 4. Fragmented apps and accounts
 - Fans must navigate a confusing constellation of F1 apps and logins, several of which sound like they should do that same thing but don't:
 - The "F1 access" login on the homepage cannot open the account with the ticket [1].
 - The official F1 app / timing app cannot retrieve ticket information [1].
 - The actual ticket often lives in separate circuit event app, each with its own account, requiring download and email/ SMS validation before the event [13]
 - -F1 TV, F1 race programme, paddock club are yet more separate apps

- As a result, it creates a repeated question of “which app/account do I use, and where is my ticket” confusing the user. Additionally confusing the user more with naming collision such as the F1 app vs F1 access.

5. Delivery & entry anxiety

- Buyers frequently report the tickets arrive only days or even sometimes ~30 hours before event. User describing the experience as a “scary feeling” and in worse cases that were never sent at all or orders cancelled without explanation close to the event [6][8][9]. Late delivery is partly by design but reads to customers as risk.
- Mobile only entry fragility: for most modern races, entry is a QR/barcode on the phone, often activating only shortly before gates and needing to be pre-downloaded [13][14]. This creates a risk on a race day, such as dead battery, cracked screen, no signal at the gate, or a screenshot instead of the live ticket can block entry. There is little tolerance built in for these failure modes.

6. Policy, price & customer service friction.

- **Rigid policies:** Orders are generally non-refundable and non-changeable; buyers acknowledge this at checkout but still tries to argue it’s a problem caused by F1, not theirs.
- **Reseller markups & “official-looking” confusion:** Several sites present as official but sell above the Retail Price on the official website. Some buyers paid €417~ (\$680 AUD) for a ticket whose printed face value was €350~ (\$570 AUD), with that buyers confirming they buy the ticket as bulk. Which fans repeatedly warn each other to buy from the circuit to avoid markups.
- **Fraud risk:** F1 has had to warn fans multiple times about the tickets on unofficial sites may vary in price and the ticket won’t be valid therefore unable to enter into the circuit on the day.
- **Slow /unhelpful support:** Reviewers described waiting weeks for a reply, with some message feels like a formulaic or AI-sounding responses, and contradictory information from phone agents [2][3][8].
- **General price sentiment:** The current state of F1 tickets and hospitality feels like a “money grab” even on the official site [2].
- Document Escalation: During the Las Vegas 2023 refund case. He clearest evidence that policy/refund friction can boil over into legal action: after the 2023 Las Vegas Grand Prix opening night was cut to a few minutes of

running and ricket holders were cleared from the grandstands before the rescheduled 2:30am session, buyers filed a class action against Liberty Media / Las Vegas Grand Prix, Inc. Organisers initially offered only a \$200 merchandise voucher limited to single day ticket holders, which fans and their counsel rejected as inadequate. Many “wanted their money back,” not store credit [16]. The case was later resolved via a settlement offering affected attendees a partial refund, reported in 2026 [16]. This illustrates how the combination of rigid refund policy, opaque compensation, and poor communication turns a one off event problem into a systemic trust failure.

7. Adjacent F1 app quality (context)

- Although not strictly “booking”, the surrounding F1 apps shape trust in the whole ecosystem, and they draw heavy criticism :
 - The official F1 app was hit with one-star reviews after a redesign that fans felt “dumbed down” the live timing screen [10].
 - F1 TV is repeatedly called buggy with crashes, buffering, broken Chromecast and no Apple TV app despite a premium price [11][15].
 - The F1 Race programme app has been criticised for inconsistent, confusing navigation and pages that don’t fit the screen
- A fan who finds the fee apps buggy is primed to distrust the paid booking flow.

Sources:

1. F1 Ticket Store — Frequently Asked Questions · *Official policy page*

Confirms no online seat selection (promoter allocates on a first-come basis), that “F1 Access” and the ticketing account are separate, that the official timing/ticketing app cannot access tickets, and that orders are generally non-refundable and non-changeable.

<https://tickets.formula1.com/en/t-111-faq>

2. Trustpilot — Official F1 Ticket Store · *Review platform*

Buyer reviews reporting undisclosed restricted-view seats, day-tickets shown “sold out” while still available at the circuit, non-refundable friction, slow support, and “money grab” price sentiment.

<https://www.trustpilot.com/review/tickets.formula1.com>

3. Malay Mail / TODAY — Singapore GP 2022 on-sale · *Press / news*

Reporting on the Singapore Grand Prix on-sale: virtual queues of roughly 3.5–6 hours, buyers kicked out of the queue, and payment/link failures during the purchase window.

<https://www.malaymail.com/news/singapore/2022/04/14/first-wave-of-f1-singapore-night-race-tickets-sell-out-as-fans-slam-online/2053439>

4. Teambblind — “F1 tickets Austin 2022” thread · *Forum / social post*

Public community thread (posted with #Formula1 hashtags) describing a presale checkout that “hung forever,” and the official channel showing “sold out” while resellers openly listed inflated inventory.

<https://www.teamblind.com/post/f1-tickets-austin-2022-4goeqtko>

5. The Independent / AOL — F1 75 Live (O2) fraudulent-ticket warning ·

Press / news

Coverage of F1 warning fans that tickets for its season-launch event listed on unofficial resale platforms could be fraudulent and invalid for entry.

<https://www.aol.com/news/f1-issues-fraudulent-ticket-warning-163817416.html>

6. Trustpilot — Motorsport Tickets · *Review platform*

Reseller reviews describing last-minute order cancellations without explanation (e.g. Monza/Monaco 2026) and delayed refunds.

<https://www.trustpilot.com/review/motorsporttickets.com>

7. Trustpilot — F1tickets.com · *Review platform*

Reviews reporting reseller markups above printed face value and slow, multi-channel customer service.

<https://www.trustpilot.com/review/f1tickets.com>

8. Trustpilot — Fanatix · *Review platform*

Reviews describing F1 tickets arriving very late (around 30 hours before the event) or not being sent, and limited contact options.

<https://www.trustpilot.com/review/fanatix.com>

9. Trustpilot — F1 Store (f1store.formula1.com) · *Review platform*

Reviews on the official merchandise store covering refund/delivery problems and a report of a purchased ticket never being sent — relevant to fulfilment trust across the ecosystem.

<https://www.trustpilot.com/review/f1store.formula1.com>

10. RaceFans — official F1 app live-timing redesign backlash · *App-store reviews (via press)*

Report on a major F1 app release that fans felt “dumbed down” the live-timing screen, triggering one-star Google Play reviews and refund demands.

<https://www.racefans.net/2018/09/07/cut-down-live-timing-screen-on-new-f1-app-provoke-complaints/>

11. F1 TV — Trustpilot & JustUseApp (Apple App Store) reviews · *App-store & review platform*

User reviews of the F1 TV app: crashes, buffering, broken casting, and (historically) no Apple TV app despite a premium subscription — relevant to trust in the paid F1 digital ecosystem.

<https://www.trustpilot.com/review/f1tv.formula1.com>

<https://justuseapp.com/en/app/1315007279/f1-tv/reviews>

12. JustUseApp — F1 Race Programme (Apple App Store) reviews · *App-store reviews*

Reviews citing inconsistent, confusing navigation and pages that do not fit the screen.

<https://justuseapp.com/en/app/1561770684/f1-race-programme/reviews>

13. Apple App Store — circuit / event & hospitality apps · *App-store listings*

Official listings showing the fragmented app landscape and that the actual mobile ticket/QR often lives in a circuit-specific app: F1 Las Vegas, F1 Miami GP, Spa GP, Grand Prix Plaza Paddock Pass, and F1 Paddock Club.

<https://apps.apple.com/app/id6449044191>

<https://apps.apple.com/cm/app/f1-crypto-com-miami-gp/id1615853991>

<https://apps.apple.com/app/spa-gp/id6447350448>

<https://apps.apple.com/us/app/f1-paddock-club/id6744975608>

14. Fastway1 Insight — F1 ticket formats guide (mobile / PDF / app entry) · *Reference / guide*

Explains that most F1 races now use mobile QR/app entry, tickets are pre-downloaded and activate near the event — context for gate-entry fragility (battery, screen, connectivity).

<https://www.fastway1.com/insight/do-you-need-to-print-your-f1-ticket-mobile-pdf-app-entry>

15. Quora — F1 TV app user experience · *Forum / community*

First-person account of the F1 TV app being buggy, with broken Chromecasting and frequent crashes.

<https://www.quora.com/How-has-your-experience-been-with-the-Formula-One-F1TV-app>

16. Las Vegas GP 2023 ticket-holder class action & 2026 partial-refund settlement · *Press / court record*

Fans forced from the grandstands before the rescheduled 2:30 a.m. session filed a class action against Liberty Media / Las Vegas Grand Prix, Inc.; an initial \$200 merchandise voucher (single-day holders only) was rejected as inadequate, and a settlement later granted affected attendees a partial refund (reported 2026). Hardens the refund/policy-friction finding with a documented legal outcome.

<https://www.npr.org/2023/11/19/1214079686/formula-1-lawsuit-las-vegas-grand-prix>

<https://www.cbsnews.com/news/formula-one-fans-class-action-lawsuit-forced-to-exit-las-vegas-grand-prix-locals-frustrated>

<https://www.racefans.net/2026/08/01/fans-who-attended-2023-las-vegas-grand-prix-offered-partial-refund/>